Working with TaskBrain

TaskBrain is a capture-and-follow-through assistant. You talk to it in a 1:1 Teams chat or by text message. Send a complete thought in ordinary language. It figures out what you want and uses the right source. You do not need special phrases.

Use a 1:1 chat for this. In a group chat it can look things up, and it will not save personal notes or assign work.

Looking something up happens right away. Saving, assigning, scheduling, or changing a shared system comes back as a preview first. Reply `approve pa-…` (or tap Approve) only when the preview is what you asked for. Nothing is written until you do.

The first time it needs your Microsoft 365 account, it sends a sign-in card in the Teams chat. One sign-in covers Teams and text message: your calendar, mail, files, and To Do.

Work through these in any order. Swap in real people, meetings, and projects.

Remember something

File a note or a personal task.

> `Capture: follow up with Morgan on commissioning Friday.`

> `Add a task to call Pat tomorrow.`

A task also lands in Microsoft To Do. If you change your mind within about 15 minutes, say undo. That removes the note. It does not delete the To Do task.

Ask about your calendar

It searches your Outlook calendar only: whether and when you met someone, the subject, and who was there.

> `When did I last meet with Joe?`

> `Did I have anything with Adam this week?`

Creating, moving, or declining an event waits for your approval. It cannot open someone else's calendar.

Ask about your mail

It can search your mailbox and the shared mailbox.

> Find the last email from Morgan about commissioning.

> Check the shared mailbox for the latest from Morgan.

Drafts and sends wait for approval, and they go out from your mailbox.

> Draft a reply to Pat and wait for my approval.

Find a file

It can search and read OneDrive or SharePoint files you can already open.

> Find the commissioning notes in my files.

Editing a text file waits for approval.

Ask what a meeting decided

Stored meeting summaries cover about the last 90 days: decisions, discussion, and who committed to what. Use your calendar for when a meeting happened, and a summary for what happened in it.

> What did we decide about commissioning last week?

> What are the action items and due dates from the commissioning meeting?

> List my open commitments.

Ask who owns what

The directory has people, teams, what someone is supposed to own, how loaded they are, and how they prefer to receive work.

> What is Val supposed to own?

> Who is on the operations team?

Hand work to someone

Name the person and the work. It checks whether that fits what they own and what is already on their plate, then assigns only if you still want that owner.

> Assign Morgan the generator warranty review due Thursday.

Leave the owner off and it recommends someone.

> Who should own the risk register update?

Check a Smartsheet

Name the project and the question in ordinary words. It finds the closest sheet, row, and column.

> What's open on the commissioning risk register?

A change comes back as an approval that names the sheet, row, and column. Check those names before you approve.

> Mark commissioning done and push the date to Friday.

Ask it to check in on a schedule

Recurring notes come back to the same chat. Times are US Central.

> Every Friday at 4 PM send me a digest of open risks.

> List my jobs.

> Cancel the Friday risk digest.

Ask a public question

It can search the public web. It cannot sign in to a site, and it does not use the web for private calendar, mail, meeting, or sheet data.

> What's the current EPA rule on generator air permits?

Keep going in the same chat

It keeps this private chat for about 24 hours, so you can refer back without repeating yourself.

> What about the second one?

When a reply is hard to read

Chat replies stay short. If you want the full version in your inbox, say:

> Email me this.

It sends from your mailbox to your own address, and it waits for your approval first. The first time, it will ask for your email address.

A few things it will not do

- Open another person's calendar or mailbox.
- Send mail, change a sheet, or change your calendar without showing you a preview first.
- Treat a quoted or hypothetical instruction as permission to act.
- Invent an answer when a source is empty or you are not signed in. It says so instead.